

# It Plays Music At Your Command (Line)



With CMus, you don't need a memory-hungry GUI music application just to enjoy your music and manage your collection.

After trying out a multitude of GUI music players like Rhythmbox, Exaile, Amarok, and even Quoad Libet, I couldn't find even one that was easy on my old and withered system. Every one of these graphical players was too slow to respond and would cause numerous system freezes. Finally, I decided to give console music players a try.

Initially, I was not willing to go for the console alternatives for many reasons – the main one being the lack of features and clumsy interfaces of most of these players. Besides, many people are reluctant to use these players due to the steep learning curve involved.

All graphical players have some major strengths, mostly related to the library functions and features like a tree view. Instead of the usual multi-window approach taken by most console music players, the tree browsing saves precious space. Some players come with the capability to display

lyrics and artist information on-the-fly.

So, the main thing you need to prepare yourself for is that a CLI is not a GUI. You will not see album art flying around or any flashy visualisations (though, with some hacking, you can achieve this).

Having gone through almost all the other alternatives, I was not concerned with these shortcomings of CLI players, in general. After some Googling, I decided to give CMus a try—mainly due to its very comprehensive feature set.

## The CMus (also called C\*) Music Player

CMus music player is what you can call the *vi* of music. It is an ncurses-based music player that uses keybindings of *vi(m)* for navigation and other purposes. Plus, the keys are configurable. You can get the bindings you want. It also has configurable colour schemes, which can be looked upon